Week 3 Homework Pack

Five subjects, about 40 minutes each, spread across the week

Rhythm for every subject: warm-up on last week's skill (5 min, online), the drill (10 min, online), then the written task on paper (20 to 25 min). Read the method box, put the page away, then write. One new habit per subject, and every written task is in full sentences.

Day	Subject	This week's one skill	Writing emphasis
Mon	Maths	Written method and checking	Do not just show numbers. For every step, write one short sentence saying what you did and why,…
Tue	Science	The Because Chain (cause, effect, consequence)	Every explanation is a chain. Write full sentences where each one connects to the next. A list …
Wed	History	So What? (developed explanation)	Evidence says what happened. So What says what it reveals. Write full, developed sentences: thi…
Thu	English	Quote, effect, So What (symbolism)	Move from naming a technique to explaining what it does and why the writer chose it. Aim for si…
Fri	Geography	Case-study evidence plus a judgement	Write about a named place with specific facts, then commit to a judgement that compares two sid…

Rules for the week

- Use your own class notes and books for facts. If you cannot find a fact, write **source needed** and ask your teacher. Do not google and copy.
- Handwriting stays tidy but does not need to be perfect. Thinking and explaining are the point.
- Stop at the time limit. A finished short answer beats an unfinished long one.
- When you finish a subject, say one thing out loud to a parent: "So what does that tell us?"

Maths: Multiplying Fractions

Skill: Written method and checking | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 20 min

Writing target

- Do not just show numbers. For every step, write one short sentence saying what you did and why, using the link words below.
- Link words: so / because / which means / therefore / this works because / first … then …

The method (use it every time)

- 1. Turn mixed numbers into improper fractions.
- 2. Cancel across first: any top and any bottom that share a factor can be divided down.
- 3. Multiply the tops. Multiply the bottoms.
- 4. Simplify, and turn back into a mixed number if the answer is top-heavy.
- 5. Check: round everything to whole numbers and estimate. Is your answer close?

A. No calculator. Show every step.

(a) 2/3 × 3/4 = (b) 5/6 × 9/10 = (c) 3/8 × 4/9 = (d) 3/5 of 40 =

B. Mixed numbers.

(e) 1½ × 2 2/3 = (f) 2 1/4 × 1 1/3 =

C. Estimate first, then calculate.

3 4/5 × 2 1/6. My estimate: _____ Exact answer: _____ Close enough? Yes / No

D. Spot the error.

A pupil writes 1½ × 1½ = 1¼ (they did 1×1 = 1 and ½×½ = ¼). What went wrong, and what is the correct answer? Write two sentences.

E. Explain it in words.

Explain why 2/3 × 3/4 is smaller than both 2/3 and 3/4. Then explain why we can cancel before multiplying. Use *because* or *which means* in each answer.

F. Worked solution in sentences (writing practice).

A tank holds 2½ litres. 3/5 of it is used, then 1/3 of what is left is poured out. How much is left? Write the solution as **sentences**, one per step, each saying what you did and why. Start: *First, I turned 2½ into an improper fraction because…*

Self-check: [ ] Mixed numbers converted first [ ] Cancelled before multiplying [ ] Simplified [ ] Estimate matches [ ] Every step has a because

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1	Numbers only. Answer may be right but the working is not explained.
Level 2	Words say what was done at each step.
Level 3	Words say what was done AND why each step is allowed.

Science: Forces

Skill: The Because Chain (cause, effect, consequence) | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 20 min

Writing target

- Every explanation is a chain. Write full sentences where each one connects to the next. A list of facts stays at Level 1.
- Link words: so / which means / because / therefore / as a result / this causes / until

The Because Chain

- Cause -> Effect -> Consequence, joined by so, which means, because, therefore.
- The key link in forces is the **resultant force**: balanced (zero) means no change in speed; unbalanced means speed or direction changes.
- Weight = mass × gravitational field strength (use g = 10 N/kg today).

Q1 (1 mark) Calculate the weight of a 6 kg mass on Earth.

Q2 (3 marks) A box is pushed forwards with a force of 40 N. Friction of 15 N acts against it. (i) State the resultant force and its direction. (ii) What happens to the speed of the box? (iii) Give one reason for your answer to (ii).

Q3 (4 marks) A cyclist stops pedalling on a flat road and gradually slows down until they stop. Explain why.

Q4 (6 marks) A lorry travels at a steady 20 m/s on a flat motorway. The driver presses the accelerator harder. After a while the lorry settles at a new, higher steady speed. Explain, in terms of forces, why the lorry first speeds up and then stops speeding up.

Plan your chain first (a short phrase in each box):

Cause	Effect	Consequence	Next link

Self-check: [ ] Used the words resultant force [ ] Every sentence links to the next [ ] Units included (N) [ ] Ended by saying what happens to speed

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1 (1-2 marks)	Points stated but not linked.
Level 2 (3-4 marks)	Attempts at logical linking, with gaps.
Level 3 (5-6 marks)	Points detailed and logically linked into a clear account.

History: The Black Death

Skill: So What? (developed explanation) | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 25 min

Writing target

- Evidence says what happened. So What says what it reveals. Write full, developed sentences: this is the biggest jump between levels.
- Link words: this suggests that / this reveals a society in which / underlying this was / which meant that / as a result / this was rare, which suggests

Remember the one habit

- Evidence tells us **what** happened. So What tells us what it **reveals**: what people believed, feared, wanted or depended on.
- Test: can you point back at your Evidence and show how your So What follows from it? If not, it is guessing.
- **Model (Rome):** *Slaves were legally property, which suggests that Roman society did not expect fairness for those at the bottom, because their labour was treated as something the powerful could own.*

Part 1: Evidence and claim check (7 min)

Write three facts about the Black Death from your class notes or memory. Use a name, date, number or place in each. Check each against your notes and circle one: supported / check / source needed.

My fact (with a date, number, name or place)	Claim check (circle one)
1.	supported / check / source needed
2.	supported / check / source needed
3.	supported / check / source needed

Part 2: So What drill (5 min)

Write only the So What sentence for each fact. Start with a link word from the box.

Part 3: Two paragraphs of a 12-mark answer (15 min)

Question: Explain why the Black Death had such a big impact on the lives of people in the Middle Ages. (12 marks)

Write only **two reasons** today. Each one: Point, Evidence, So What, in full sentences. Use only facts you marked supported.

Reason 1

Reason 2

Part 4: Self-check (3 min)

[ ] Every Evidence sentence is followed by a So What [ ] I can point back to the Evidence for each So What

[ ] No fact marked check or source needed is in my writing [ ] No modern word a person in the Middle Ages would not have used

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1	General statements, little specific evidence.
Level 2	Some explanation but evidence is generic.
Level 3	Developed explanation with specific evidence for each reason.
Level 4	As Level 3, plus reasons linked and ranked (not yet the target).

Oral check (parent): pick one Evidence sentence and ask “So what does that tell us?” She answers without reading.

English: Tsunami Girl

Skill: Quote, effect, So What (symbolism) | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 20 min

Writing target

- Move from naming a technique to explaining what it does and why the writer chose it. Aim for six to eight linked sentences.
- Link words: this suggests that / this makes the reader feel / which implies / by choosing …, the writer / symbolises / as a result

How to think about symbolism

- A **symbol** is a concrete thing (object, image, place, character, even the form of the book) that stands for a bigger idea.
- Spot it: it appears more than once, or the writer lingers on it. Think about the manga hero Yuki creates, the sea, or an object that returns. Choose from **your own copy**.
- Ladder: **Label** -> **Effect** -> **So What**.
- The book mixes prose and manga. Ask why the writer switches at this moment.

Part 1: Reading log (3 min)

In two or three lines, what has happened in the chapters you have read so far?

Part 2: Choose and plan (5 min)

Step	Your notes
My symbol, and where it appears	
What it literally is	
Short quote (8 words or fewer) and page	
Two ideas it could stand for	
Which fits best, and why	

Part 3: One paragraph (12 min)

Question: How does the writer use your chosen symbol to help us understand Yuki's feelings or situation?

Frame: The writer uses ___ (quote). This makes the reader feel or think ___. This suggests that ___ because ___. By choosing this, the writer shows ___.

Self-check: [ ] Quote exact and short [ ] Named an effect on the reader [ ] So What goes beyond the plot [ ] Gave a reason with because

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1	Quote and plot only.
Level 2	Effect on the reader is named.
Level 3	Effect and So What, with a reason, in your own words.

Oral check (parent): “What did the writer want us to understand by choosing that?”

Geography: Megacities

Skill: Case-study evidence plus a judgement | Warm-up 5, drill 10, paper 20 min

Writing target

- Write about a named place with specific facts, then commit to a judgement that compares two sides and says which is bigger and why.
- Link words: overall / whereas / however / this outweighs / mattered more than … because / although

Quick reference

- A **megacity** is usually a city with more than 10 million people.
- Growth comes from **rural-urban migration** (push and pull factors) and **natural increase**.
- **Opportunities**: jobs, schools and hospitals, services. **Problems**: housing shortages (slums), traffic, pollution, waste, pressure on water and services.
- A top answer uses a **named place** with **specific evidence**, then makes a **judgement** by comparing.

Part 1: My case-study card, from class notes (7 min)

Item	From my notes
Megacity and country	
Population (number and year)	
One opportunity, with a specific fact	
One problem, with a specific fact	
Claim check: supported / check / source needed	

If your notes have no case study, write source needed and ask your teacher which one the class used.

Part 2: Write it up (13 min)

Question: “Megacities bring more opportunities than problems.” How far do you agree? (6 marks)

Opportunity: evidence, then So What. Problem: evidence, then So What. Finish with a judgement that compares: Overall, … mattered more than … because …

Self-check: [ ] Named place used [ ] Specific facts, not general ones [ ] Both sides covered [ ] Judgement says which side is bigger and why

Mark your writing: circle the level you reached.

Level	What it looks like
Level 1	General statements about cities.

Level 2	Specific facts for one side; the other barely mentioned.
Level 3	Specific facts for both sides and a clear, justified judgement.

Parent Page

Answers, oral checks and the weekly review. Not for the pupil until the work is done.

Maths: Maths answers

A: (a) 1/2 (b) 3/4 (c) 1/6 (d) 24. B: (e) 4 (f) 3. C: estimate 4 × 2 = 8; exact 247/30 = 8 7/30. D: whole and fraction parts were multiplied separately; correct is 3/2 × 3/2 = 9/4 = 2¼. E: a part of a part is smaller than either; cancelling works because dividing top and bottom by the same number does not change the value, and it keeps the numbers small. F: 2½ L = 5/2 L; 3/5 used = 3/2 L; left 1 L; 1/3 of 1 L poured out = 1/3 L; left 2/3 L.

Maths: Oral check

Ask: “Why is the answer smaller than the fractions you started with?” She should answer in a full sentence with because.

Science: Science answers

Q1: 60 N. Q2: 25 N forwards; speed increases because the forces are unbalanced. Q3: no driving force, so friction and air resistance give a resultant force backwards, so deceleration until stopped. Q4 should link: driving force greater than resistance, so resultant forwards and acceleration; resistance rises with speed; at the new speed driving force equals resistance, forces balanced, resultant zero, speed constant.

Science: Oral check

Ask: “Walk me through the chain.” Listen for so and which means joining the steps.

History: History

Marked by reading. For each Evidence sentence, is there a grounded So What? Can she point back? Are any claims she marked check still in her writing? The oral check should be answered without reading.

History: Graduation rule

Move to the next habit only after two consecutive pieces where most Evidence sentences have a grounded So What and she passes the oral check unaided.

English: English

Marked by reading. Look for a short exact quote, a named effect on the reader, and an idea beyond the plot. If she cannot find a symbol, point her to the prose-to-manga switch.

English: Note

I assumed her class is reading Tsunami Girl by Julian Sedgwick and Chie Kutsuwada. Ask which chapter the class is on if you want the paragraph to match.

Geography: Geography

Marked by reading. Named city, two specific facts, both sides, and a judgement that compares rather than repeats.

Geography: Note

I assumed the topic and case study from her single word, megacities. Confirm with her notes which city the class used.

Weekly review (5 min, J)

Subject	Minutes taken	What was weak	What changes next week
Maths			
Science			
History			
English			
Geography			